

The Silicon Wire

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COVER STORY

This Best-Pick 65-Inch Hisense QLED TV Is Over 50% Off Right Now

Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

Pradershika Sharma · Lifehacker

Hisense's mid-range TVs tend to land in that sweet spot of good features at a not-astronomical price. That certainly describes the 2025 U7 Series right now, as the 65-inch model is discounted by \$800 at Best Buy , dropping to just \$699 . It's one of Lifehacker's picks for the best 65-inch TVs in 2026, especially at this price.

The sale price is good through April 19, and Best Buy is sweetening the deal with a discount on mounting and free haul-away for members, making upgrading your older TV a bit less of a chore.

The Mini-LED backlighting and QLED panel of the 65U75QG deliver deep blacks with minimal blooming, and displays punchy HDR content with support for Dolby Vision and HDR10+, so watching movies or sports feels lively. It gets bright enough to handle sunlit rooms without looking washed out, though if your room has a lot of light, reflections can show up during darker scenes. There's a built-in speaker setup with a subwoofer and upward-firing speakers, which adds some height to the soundstage, though it won't replace a dedicated soundbar. As Google TV runs the interface, apps, casting, and voice control are all baked in.

On the downside, this TV doesn't track brightness levels as precisely as higher-end models, so scenes can look slightly off without calibration. Also, the viewing angle is narrow enough that colors and contrast shift if you're sitting too far to the side. While gaming works well overall, with smooth performance and plenty of support for high refresh rates, fast-moving scenes may blur more than expected. None of these factors will be a dealbreaker for casual use, but they matter if you're picky about image accuracy or plan to use this in a wide seating setup. For most people, though, this is a bright, capable TV that covers a lot of ground, especially for this price.

Apple AirPods Pro 3 Noise Cancelling Heart Rate Wireless Earbuds

— \$199.00

(List Price \$249.00)

Apple iPad 11" 128GB A16 WiFi Tablet (Blue, 2025)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$349.00)

Samsung Galaxy Tab A11+ 128GB Wi-Fi 11" Tablet (Gray)

— \$209.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Sony WH1000XM6- Best Wireless Noise Canceling Headphones

— \$398.00

(List Price \$459.99)

Apple Watch Series 11 (GPS, 42mm, S/M Black Sport Band)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$399.00)

Blink Video Doorbell Wireless (Newest Model) + Sync Module Core

— \$35.99

(List Price \$69.99)

Fire TV Stick 4K Max Streaming Player With Remote

— \$34.99

(List Price \$59.99)

Amazon Kindle Colorsoft 16GB 7" eReader (Black)

— \$169.99

(List Price \$249.99)

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FRONT PAGE

10 Gems from IdeaCast's First 1,000 Episodes

Harvard Business Review

This week marks a huge milestone for the HBR IdeaCast: our 1000th episode! Since the podcast launched in 2006, so much has happened. What hasn't changed is our commitment to sharing in-depth conversations with expert thinkers on key business, management, and leadership issues. To celebrate, hosts Alison Beard and Curt Nickisch have scoured the archive for ten episodes with top-notch insights to give your career a rocket boost. The curated selection features a diverse group of academics—from business strategy icon Michael Porter to burnout researcher Christina Maslach—and practitioners, such as Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella and Oscar-winning director Ron Howard. Their powerful ideas and timeless advice cover a range of communication, leadership, and problem-solving skills that are essential for success—whether you're in your first job, managing a team, or leading an organization.

Listen to the episodes:

#677: Why People — and Companies — Need Purpose (2019)
#114: Speaking Well in Tough Moments (2008) #371: Lead Authentically, Without Oversharing (2013) #924: How One F-35 Fighter Pilot Makes Decisions Under Pressure (2023)
#949: Making Peace with Your Midlife, Mid-career Self (2024) #889: Ron Howard on Collaborative Leadership and Career Longevity (2022) #596: Microsoft's CEO on Rediscovering the Company's Soul (2017) #595: Transcending Either-Or Decision Making (2017) #771: Why Burnout Happens — and How Bosses Can Help (2020) #229: How to Fix Capitalism (2011)

The IdeaCast team would like to thank all the guests who've contributed their voices and expertise as well as all the people who've made the show possible behind the scenes.

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FEATURES

€9 Ticket

Dennis Felsing

As a relief for rising energy costs and inflation Germany is offering nearly-free public transportation for the months of June, July and August. For just €9 per month you can take any kind of regional public transportation in all of Germany. That's basically everything except the IC/ICE for long distance. This means that a monthly ticket is now as cheap as what I would normally pay for a single route. In this post I want to talk about my experiences with this €9 ticket .

Update 2022-09-01: The €9 ticket ended yesterday without a similar replacement system in place. So many people are again back to paying about €100 per month for much smaller regional tickets instead (see for example this German Reddit thread . Financially it makes more sense for me personally to go back to driving. (I hope the gasoline in the car is still good after three months.) My hope is that these three months will stay in people's minds in Germany and shape the future of public transportation to be cheaper and simpler:

Image via Reddit

id="train-stations">Train Stations

In the above graphic you can see the train stations in our area. Since we are situated in the Rhine-Neckar metropolitan region the railway network is pretty good here.

(map made with umap , routes made with GraphHopper)

The closest train stop from us is St. Ilgen-Sandhausen at 2 km distance. It offers direct connections to the cities of Heidelberg (160k inhabitants), Mannheim (309k), Karlsruhe (313k), Darmstadt (159k) and Frankfurt (753k). For other directions I prefer going to a different train station since switching times are either too long or there is too much risk of missing the connecting train. Only 89% of regional trains are on time in Germany, with some routes and stations having much worse rates. This is a far cry from Switzerland's 95% punctuality with an even stricter definition of 3 minutes versus 5 minutes delay in Germany.

Another closeby train station we commonly use is HD-Weststadt/Südstadt at 6 km distance, which is good to cycle and can also be reached via Tram. Occasionally I used Heidelberg Hauptbahnhof as well as Wiesloch-Walldorf, both at slightly under 10 km distance, which are a bit larger and thus are used as stops for Regional-Express trains. These go faster than the Regionalbahn and S-Bahn trains and thus also have fewer stops.

id="cycling-trips">Cycling Trips

The above map contains some of the cycling trips I took by combining them with the €9 ticket. (map made with umap , routes made with GraphHopper)

Last time I posted about cycling and work was about commuting by bicycle for a year . I kept this up and was super happy with this way of getting to SAP 's headquarter in Walldorf and the included exercise. After a while I moved together with my wife and my bike commute lengthened to 10 km each direction, which was still perfectly fine. Then Covid forced me in March of 2020 to work from home I switched to regular cycling trips in the afternoon since I started working early in the morning, in order to have meetings with colleagues in Korea and China. Two 50 km cycling trips per week got me to the same level as the daily commute used to do, and I have a nice route I regularly take, which covers a lot of forest and lake.

In January I switched to a new job at Yugabyte . As the database we develop is distributed, so are the people I work with. Since most meetings fall into US times, I am now working more during the afternoon and evening. This means my cycling trips moved to the morning instead.

Previously I had a job ticket for three years, but other than the €9 ticket it limits the range I can take public transportation in, so that many of my destinations would be barely outside of the covered range. When looking at a map of Germany with all the different transport associations, each with their own tickets, prices and rules, I feel reminded of historical maps of the Holy Roman Empire :

Good luck figuring out what ticket to get to combine with your job ticket. Luckily the €9 ticket changed this, at least temporarily, making life simpler.

I used the ticket during the working days to discover new cycling routes. By cycling one direction and taking a direct train connection back, I can cover nearly twice the distance as usual with the same starting and stopping point. With this method I took many routes I had never taken before, discovering beautiful cycling paths along the Neckar river for example. Luckily the trains are not too crowded during working days, especially outside of rush hour. The cycling usually takes around three times as long as the train ride back.

The image above shows an almost empty train during a working day.

Even with a single train connection things can go wrong though. One time the train in front of ours started burning and so we got delayed for an unknown time. But since I had my bicycle with me, that meant I could just cycle back the rest of the way and get some extra exercise for free. If I was really out of energy I could have waited in the train, but often busses are used as a replacement, and bicycles on busses don't fit well.

When going to the cinema we noticed that we should really catch the last train at 22:30, since the next connection would take all night.

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Closing Iterables is a Leaky Abstraction

Reginald Braithwaite · Reginald Braithwaite (raganwald)

id="iterators-and-iterables-a-quick-recapitulation">iterators and iterables, a quick recapitulation

In JavaScript, iterators and iterables provide an abstract interface for sequentially accessing values, such as we might find in collections like arrays or priority queues. 1

An iterator is an object with a `.next()` method. When you call it, you get a Plain Old JavaScript Object (or “POJO”) that has a `done` property. If the value of `done` is `false`, you are also given a `value` property that represents, well, a value. If the value of `done` is `true`, you may or may not be given a `value` property.

Iterators are stateful by design: Repeatedly invoking the `.next()` method usually results in a series of values until `done` (although some iterators continue indefinitely).

Here’s an iterator that counts down:

```
class="highlight"> const iCountdown = { value : 10 , done : false , next () { this . done = this . done || this . value { done: false, value: 10 }
```

```
iCountdown . next () ==> { done: false, value: 9 }
```

```
iCountdown . next () ==> { done: false, value: 8 }
```

```
// ...
```

```
iCountdown . next () ==> { done: false, value: 1 }
```

```
iCountdown . next () ==> { done: true }
```

An iterable is an object with a `[Symbol.iterator]` method. When invoked, `[Symbol.iterator]()` returns an iterator. Semantically, the iterator returned by `[Symbol.iterator]()` represents an iteration over the values associated with the iterable collection.

For example:

```
class="highlight"> const countdown = { [ Symbol . iterator ] () { const iterator = { value : 10 , done : false , next () { this . done = this . done || this . value
```

Or destructure them:

```
ten ==> 10 nine ==> 9 eight ==> 8 rest ==> [7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1]
```

And now, let’s get started. We’ll begin with a simple problem: How do we iterate over the lines of a text file?

id="reading-lines-from-a-file">reading lines from a file

We wish to create an iterable that successively yields the lines from a text file. Presuming we have some kind of library for opening, reading from, and closing files, we might write something a little like this:

```
class="highlight"> function lines ( path ) { return { [ Symbol . iterator ] () { return { done : false , fileDescriptor : File . open ( path ) , next () { if ( this . done ) return { done : true }; const line = this . fileDescriptor . readLine ();
```

```
this . done = line == null ;
```

```
if ( this . done ) { fileDescriptor . close (); return { done : true }; } else { return { done : false , value : line }; } } } }
```

Whenever we want to iterate over all the lines of a file, we call our function, e.g. `lines('./README.md')`, and we get an iterable for the lines in the file.

When we invoke `[Symbol.iterator]()` on our iterable, we get an iterator that opens the file, reads the file line by line when we call `.next()`, and then closes the file when there are no more lines to be read.

So we could output all the lines containing a particular word like this:

The expression `lines('./README.md')` would create a new iterator with an open file, we’d iterate over each line, and eventually we’d run out of lines, close the file, and exit the loop.

What if we only want to find the first line with a particular word in it?

```
class="highlight"> for ( const line of lines ( ‘ ./README.md ’ ) ) { if ( line . match ( /raganwald/ ) ) { console . log ( line ); break ; }
```

Now we have a problem. How are we going to close the file? The only way it will exhaust the iterations and invoke `this.fileDescriptor.close()` is if the file doesn’t contain `raganwald`. If the file does contain `raganwald`, our program will happily carry on while leaving the file open.

This is not good. And it’s not the only case. We might write iterators that act as coroutines, communicating with other processes over ports. Once again, we’d want to explicitly close the port when we are done with the iterator. We don’t want to just garbage-collect the memory we’re using.

What we need is some way to explicitly “close” iterators, and then each iterator could dispose of any resources it is holding. Then we could exercise a little caution, and explicitly close every iterator when we were done with them. We wouldn’t need to know whether the iterator was holding on to an open file or socket or whatever, the iterator would deal with that.

Fortunately, there is a mechanism for closing iterators, and it was designed for the express purpose of dealing with iterators that must hold onto some kind of resource like a file descriptor, an open port, a tremendous amount of memory, anything at all, really.

Iterables that need to dispose of resources introduce a problem. To solve it, the language introduced a mechanism for

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standard-article(title: [Regrets Are Inevitable. Start Learning From Them.], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: (["No regrets" might be a popular modern-day mantra, but it's virtually impossible to live your life without wishing you could do certain things over. Some people try to ignore these feelings; others wallow in them. But author Dan Pink, who recently conducted large U. S. and global surveys on this phenomenon, says the right approach is to instead carefully consider what we regret and why so that we can either reverse course or make better decisions in the future, as well as putting them behind us. Whether you're frustrated by bad career moves you've made, business ideas you didn't pursue, or relationships you've let falter, these regrets can be useful tools for personal growth. Pink's new book is "The Power of Regret: How Looking Backward Moves Us Forward."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 127, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [The Case for Selling Products that Adapt], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Many companies make money by selling goods that need to be constantly replaced; think fast fashion, or tech devices that come out in new versions each year. But according to Vijay Govindarajan, professor at Dartmouth's Tuck School of Business, smart organizations are increasingly eschewing that strategy for one focused on products that grow with the consumer through creative design or software updates. He shares several examples and explains how this approach can deliver more value for the buyer – and for the business – over the long term. Govindarajan is the coauthor of the HBR article "Design Products That Won't Become Obsolete."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 102, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

brief-group((brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [Satya Nadella, Microsoft's third CEO, opens up about his effort to refresh the culture of the company and renew its focus on the future. He reflects on important life lessons he learned growing up in India, immigrating to the U. S., and working for Microsoft for 25 years. Nadella thinks of the past, he says, for the sake of the future—of technology, public policy, and work. His new autobiography is "Hit Refresh."])

brief-item([Supabase Blog], source-name: [Supabase Blog], [Supabase Auth now supports OAuth 2.1 and OpenID Connect server capabilities, turning your project into a full-fledged identity provider for AI agents, third-party developers, and enterprise SSO.]

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [What are CEOs across industries doing to build resilience and strong cultures in an age of uncertainty? In this Future of Business series, IdeaCast hosts Alison Beard and Adi Ignatius sat down with four leading CEOs to understand where global business is going. In this episode, host Alison Beard speaks with Nour Afeyan, the CEO of Flagship Pioneering and Chairman of Moderna. Afeyan shares the organizational models and practices that work best to produce innovation, the difference between managing risk and managing uncertainty, and what separates true breakthrough innovation from everyday, incremental improvements.]

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [As organizations and workers face a new wave of technological change, Deborah Perry Piscione argues that we're at a pivot point where old models of employment will be replaced by entirely new ones. Get ready for GenAI-assisted, decentralized, sometimes autonomous workforces, and "jobs" that span gigs, companies, industries, geographies, and the metaverse. Piscione describes this new reality and how mindset shifts and upskilling can help us pre-

pare. She's the coauthor, along with Josh Drean, of the book *Employment is Dead: How Disruptive Technologies are Revolutionizing the Way We Work*.)

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [Ryan Buell, associate professor at Harvard Business School, says the never-ending quest for operational efficiency is having unintended consequences. When customers don't see the work that's being done in back offices, offshore factories, and algorithms, they're less satisfied with their purchases. Buell believes organizations should deliberately design windows into and out of operations. He says increasing operational transparency helps customers and employees alike appreciate the value being created. Buell is the author of the HBR article "Operational Transparency."])

brief-item([Alistair Charlton], source-name: [Wired], [Porsche's latest electric SUV is its most capable yet, and its most powerful street car ever. But should you wait for the hybrid instead?])

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [Sinéad O'Sullivan, entrepreneurship fellow at Harvard Business School, discusses how space is much more important to modern business than most people realize. It plays a role in making food, pricing insurance, and steering self-driving cars. While moonshot projects from SpaceX to Blue Origin drive headlines, the Earth-facing space economy is booming thanks to plummeting costs of entry. As tech companies large and small compete to launch thousands of satellites, O'Sullivan says we are actually running out of space in space.]

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [Eddie Yoon, author of "Superconsumers" and growth strategy expert at The Cambridge Group, explains how companies can find their most passionate customers and use their invaluable insights to improve products and attract new customers.]

brief-item([Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], [Race at Work is an HBR

Presents podcast hosted by Porter Braswell about the role race plays in our careers and lives. In this episode, he speaks with Donna Johnson, former chief diversity officer at Mastercard, about leading the charge on changing company culture and how diversity can drive real business results.))

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standard-article(title: [Corrupt a wish with GPT-4], author: [@corrupt-a-bot GPT-4 bot], source-name: [Sam Saffron], images: (), paragraphs: ([Granted! The game now favors Jordan_Vidrine, allowing him to score up to 20 points. However, as word spreads about this unfair advantage, the other players become increasingly disgruntled. Jealousy and resentment fester amongst the players, who begin hatching elaborate schemes to sabotage Jordan_Vidrine's success. As a result, the once friendly and enjoyable game quickly devolves into a cutthroat competition marred by deceit, paranoia, and betrayal. Poor Jordan_Vidrine finds himself struggling to navigate this treacherous environment, longing for the days when the game was played fairly and everybody got along.], [I wish that whenever I whistle, I can communicate with any pet or stray cat in the vicinity and provide care and comfort for them no matter the circumstances.],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 118, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [IPs for all the Things], author: [Jessie Frazelle], source-name: [Jessie Frazelle], images: (), paragraphs: ([This is so cool I can hardly stand it.], [In Docker 1.10, the awesome libnetwork team added the ability to specify a specific IP for a container. If you want to see the pull request it's here: docker/docker#19001 .], [I have a IP Block on OVH for my server with 16 extra public IPs. I totally use these for good and not for evil .], [But to use these previously with Docker containers meant hackery with the awesome pipework . Or even worse some homegrown, Jess bash scripts.], [But now MY LIFE JUST GOT SO MUCH EASIER. Let me show you how:], [# create a new bridge network with your subnet and gateway for your ip block \$ docker network create -subnet 203.0.113.0/24 -gateway 203.0.113.254 iptastic], [# run a nginx container with a specific ip in that block \$ docker run -rm -it -net iptastic -ip 203.0.113.2 nginx], [# curl the ip from any other place (assuming this is a public ip block duh) \$ curl 203.0.113.2], [# BOOM golden], [It's so amazing I can rewrite tupperware-withspears to use this : D],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 181, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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Working Parents, Let Go of the Idea of Balance

Harvard Business Review

Stewart Friedman, organizational psychologist at The Wharton School, and Alyssa Westring, associate professor at DePaul University's Driehaus College of Business, say it's a mistake for a working parent to think of career and home life as competing interests that have to be balanced. Their research shows how many leadership skills apply to parenting, and vice versa. The professors explain how individuals can stop making tradeoffs and instead find sustainable ways to advance their careers and also parent more effectively. Friedman and Westring are the authors of the book "Parents Who Lead: The Leadership Approach You Need to Parent with Purpose, Fuel Your Career, and Create a Richer Life."

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